



Handout 7.8: Customer Profile, Interview Sheet, and Numbers Page

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Team: _____ My role: CEO / CFO / CMO

Unit 7, Lesson 7.8. **Page 1 is the customer work. Page 2 is the money. Calculators for everybody, all period, no permission needed.**

Page 1: The customer

What we think we know (fill this in BEFORE you ask anybody)

This is the before picture. At least one of these three lines is going to turn out wrong, and that is the point.

	Our guess
Who is our customer?	
What will they pay?	\$
What do they do about this problem right now?	

The customer profile: five specifics

“Everybody” is not a customer. Everybody is what you say when you have not asked anybody.

#	Specific	Ours
1	Who? (a role, not a name: a parent, a grade 6 student, a coach, a neighbor)	
2	Age or stage of life?	
3	What do they already do about this problem? (this is your real competition)	
4	How much can they spend on this?	\$
5	Where would they hear about you?	

Example of a weak profile: people who are hungry. **Example of a strong profile:** a parent picking up a child at 3:15 who has 20 minutes and \$6.00 and right now buys a bag of chips at the deli.

The three questions. Same three for every team.

1. **Do you have this problem? Tell me about the last time.**
2. **What do you do about it right now?**
3. **If this existed, what would you pay for it, and what would make you not buy it?**

English	Spanish
Do you have this problem? Tell me about the last time.	¿Tiene usted este problema? Cuénteme la última vez.
What do you do about it right now?	¿Qué hace usted al respecto ahora?
If this existed, what would you pay for it?	Si esto existiera, ¿cuánto pagaría?
What would make you not buy it?	¿Qué haría que no lo comprara?

The recording rule

Write down what they said, not what you think they meant.

- Weak note: *he liked it.*
- Strong note: *he said "I would pay two dollars but not three, and only if it fits in my bag."*

Use quotation marks. If the interview happens in Spanish, **write it in that language** and translate one line later for the poster.

Interview 1

Who I talked to (a role, not a name): _____

Question	What they actually said
1. Do you have this problem? Last time?	
2. What do you do about it now?	
3. What would you pay? What would stop you?	\$

Interview 2

Who I talked to: _____

Question	What they actually said
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1. Do you have this problem? Last time?	
2. What do you do about it now?	
3. What would you pay? What would stop you?	\$

Interview 3

Who I talked to: _____

Question	What they actually said
1. Do you have this problem? Last time?	
2. What do you do about it now?	
3. What would you pay? What would stop you?	\$

What changed

The three prices we heard: \$_____ \$_____ \$_____

One thing we now know that we did not know at the start of this period:

One thing we are changing about our idea because of it:

Team initials: _____

Page 2: The numbers

Part A: The worked example, done with the whole class

A custom drawstring tote bag (this uses Unit 5 skills).

Line	Amount
Fabric for one bag	\$1.80
Cord	\$0.30
Thread and needle share	\$0.10
Printed paper tag	\$0.05
UNIT COST (add it up: what one costs you to make)	\$_____
PRICE (what you charge for one)	\$6.00
MARGIN (price minus unit cost: your profit on one)	\$_____
FIXED COST (paid once, no matter how many you make): a stencil kit	\$15.00
BREAK-EVEN IN UNITS (fixed cost divided by margin, rounded UP to a whole bag)	_____ bags

Say it out loud with the class: “We stop losing money after the _____ bag.”

Why rounded up? _____

Part B: Your own numbers

Unit cost: every single thing it takes to make ONE. Be annoying about it. Include the bag, the tape, the tag.

#	What you have to buy	Cost for one unit
1		\$
2		\$
3		\$
4		\$

5		\$
6		\$
	UNIT COST (total)	\$

If your idea is a service and there is nothing to buy, your unit cost is your supplies plus anything you have to replace. Write “time” on a line and leave the dollar amount at \$0.00, then write how many minutes one job takes: _____ minutes.

Price, margin, fixed cost, break-even

Line	Where the number comes from	Amount
UNIT COST	from the table above	\$
PRICE	what your three customers said they would pay	\$
MARGIN	price minus unit cost	\$
FIXED COST	anything you pay once, no matter how many you make (a kit, a stencil, a sign, a table fee). Write \$0.00 if there is none	\$
BREAK-EVEN IN UNITS	fixed cost divided by margin, rounded UP	units

Our sentence: “We stop losing money after the _____ unit.”

If your fixed cost is \$0.00, your break-even is 1 unit, and you say so: “We are profitable on the first one, because we have no fixed cost.”

The one-month projection

Line	Math	Amount
Units we think we can sell in one month		units
times MARGIN		\$
minus FIXED COST		\$



= ONE MONTH'S PROFIT		\$
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The rule that makes this honest: the number of units needs a reason that is not a guess.

- **A guess:** “We will sell 200.”
- **A reason:** “There are 88 students in our grade. All three people we interviewed said they would buy. We projected 30, which is about a third of the grade.”

Our reason for the unit number:

Grade 8 line: the same break-even at a lower price

Line	At our price	At \$1.00 less
Price	\$	\$
Margin	\$	\$
Break-even in units		

One sentence: what does dropping the price by a dollar do to how many you have to sell?

Grade 8 line: fixed and variable, separated

Fixed (same no matter how many)	\$	Variable (changes with how many)	\$

Peer number check

Read your four numbers out loud to another team. They check the arithmetic and ask you one question.

Checking team: _____

Number	Their check: right or fix it	Their one question
Unit cost		
Margin		
Break-even		
One month's profit		

Fix any error in red. Then:

CFO signature (this means the arithmetic is right): _____

Teacher initials (the gate): _____

Word bank

English	Spanish
customer	cliente
target customer	cliente objetivo
unit cost	costo unitario
price	precio
margin	margen de ganancia
break-even	punto de equilibrio
projection	proyección
fixed cost	costo fijo

Sentence frame: “We stop losing money after ___ units.” / “Dejamos de perder dinero después de ___ unidades.”